BOUNDARIES & BURNOUT

From Chaos to Clarity

"He turns our mess into a message, our tests into testimonies"

Audience	Duration	Format	Speaker
40 Women in Search & Rescue	60 Minutes	Interactive Keynote	Chelsea Flynn

⏱️ Session Timeline

Time	Segment	Type
0:00 - 0:05	Opening Hook & Welcome	Speaking
0:05 - 0:13	Personal Story: My Burnout Moment	Speaking
0:13 - 0:20	Activity #1: The Oxygen Mask Check	Group Activity
0:20 - 0:30	Teaching: The 3 B's of Burnout	Speaking
0:30 - 0:40	Activity #2: Boundary Audit	Paired Exercise
0:40 - 0:48	Teaching: The R.E.S.C.U.E. Framework	Speaking
0:48 - 0:55	Activity #3: The Non-Negotiables	Individual + Share
0:55 - 1:00	Closing & Call to Action	Speaking

📋 Materials Checklist

- ☐ Index cards (40+)
- ☐ Pens for all participants (40)
- ☐ Flip chart or whiteboard
- ☐ Markers (dark colors)
- ☐ Timer (phone works)
- ☐ Slide deck loaded & tested
- ☐ Handouts printed (optional)
- ☐ Business cards / QR code for follow-up

🎤 OPENING HOOK (5 minutes)

[Walk to center stage, pause, make eye contact]
"Raise your hand if you've ever been on a rescue mission where someone didn't follow protocol... and it nearly cost them everything."
[Pause for hands]
"Now keep your hand up if YOU have ever been that person... not on a mission, but in your own life. Running on empty. Ignoring the warning signs. Telling yourself 'I'm fine' when everything inside is screaming 'MAYDAY.'"

"My name is Chelsea Flynn. I'm a Catholic speaker, a life transformation coach, a mother of three—including a child with special needs—and a woman who once thought burnout was a badge of honor."
"You cannot rescue anyone if you are drowning yourself."

💔 PERSONAL STORY: My Burnout Moment (8 minutes)

"Let me take you back to my chaos moment. Picture this: I'm a mother of three. My youngest has autism—beautiful, brilliant, and requiring constant attention. I'm running a business. I'm saying yes to every request because I thought that's what strong women do."
[Pause, connect with audience]
"One morning, I woke up and couldn't get out of bed. Not 'didn't want to'—COULDN'T. My body had finally staged a full rebellion. I looked at my phone—47 unread messages—and felt nothing but dread."
"I had become so good at rescuing everyone else that I had completely abandoned myself."

"Boundaries aren't selfish. They're survival equipment."

ACTIVITY #1 **The Oxygen Mask Check (7 min)**

Instructions: Everyone stands. Read statements below. If TRUE for them right now, they step backward. If false, stay put.

1. "I have trouble falling asleep because my mind won't stop."
2. "I can't remember the last time I did something purely for fun."
3. "I feel guilty when I take time for myself."
4. "I've snapped at someone I love recently because I was overwhelmed."
5. "I've said 'I'm fine' in the past week when I wasn't."
6. "I feel like I'm running on fumes but keep going anyway."
7. "I've neglected basic self-care because I was 'too busy.'"

[After: "Look around. This isn't shame—this is awareness. You can't rescue yourself from a building you don't know you're trapped in."]

📚 THE 3 B'S OF BURNOUT (10 minutes)

The 3 B's of Burnout

1. BLURRED BOUNDARIES
When we can't tell where we end and everyone else begins. We take on others' emergencies as our own.

2. BURIED NEEDS
When we push our own needs so far down we forget they exist. When's the last time you asked: What do I need?

3. BROKEN BOUNDARIES
The boundaries we set and immediately violate. "No emails after 6pm" → checks at 6:01.

ACTIVITY #2 **Boundary Audit (10 min)**

Instructions: Pair up. 5 minutes each person. Partner ONLY listens—no fixing, no advice.

Questions to answer:

1. **"What is one boundary I KNOW I need to set but haven't?"**
2. **"What am I afraid will happen if I set this boundary?"**
3. **"What is ALREADY happening because I HAVEN'T set this boundary?"**

[Set timer 5 min → announce switch → 5 min more]
[After: "Sometimes just saying it out loud makes it real. And when it's real, we can change it."]

🚁 THE R.E.S.C.U.E. FRAMEWORK (8 minutes)

Personal Rescue Plan

R - RECOGNIZE the warning signs
What does YOUR burnout look like? Know your red flags.

E - ESTABLISH your non-negotiables
What are 2-3 things you MUST protect?

S - SPEAK your boundaries out loud
A boundary in your head isn't a boundary. It's a wish.

C - CREATE accountability
Tell someone. Write it down. Make it visible.

U - UNDERSTAND maintenance is required
Boundaries need daily reinforcement.

E - EXPECT pushback
People who benefited from your lack of boundaries won't celebrate new ones.

ACTIVITY #3 **The Non-Negotiables (7 min)**

Instructions: On index card, write THREE non-negotiables—things you commit to protect starting TODAY.

Examples:

- "I will not answer work calls after 8pm"
- "I will take my full lunch break"
- "I will ask for help when overwhelmed"

[Give 3 minutes to write]
[Ask for 3 volunteers to share ONE non-negotiable with the room]

Key point: "When we speak our boundaries out loud, they become real."

🎬 CLOSING & CALL TO ACTION (5 minutes)

"You are women who run toward danger when everyone else runs away. You are the ones who show up at 3am. You are the calm in someone else's worst moment. **That is extraordinary.**"
"But you are also human beings who need rest. Who need joy. Who need boundaries."

THE CHALLENGE:
"This week, enforce ONE boundary. Just one. And when that voice says 'Who do you think you are?'—answer: ***'I am someone worth rescuing too.'"***

Closing line: "Remember: He turns our mess into a message, our tests into testimonies. Your burnout doesn't have to be the end of your story. It can be the beginning of a new chapter."
[Pause]
"Now go rescue yourselves. You've earned it."

💡 Speaker Notes

Energy Management

- Start high energy, vary throughout
- Lower voice for emotional moments
- Use movement—don't stay behind podium
- Make eye contact with different sections

Audience Connection

- These women have seen trauma—be respectful
- Acknowledge their sacrifice early
- Use "we" language throughout
- Humor helps but keep it relatable

Flexibility Tips

- If an activity runs long, shorten speaking sections
- If energy is low, add more movement or call-and-response
- Read the room—adjust depth of personal sharing accordingly
- Have business cards or QR code ready for those wanting coaching

📧 Post-Event Follow-Up Email

Subject: You showed up for yourself yesterday 🙌

Hi [Name],

Thank you for being part of yesterday's session on Boundaries & Burnout. It takes courage to show up, be honest, and commit to change.

A few things to support your journey:

1. Your non-negotiables matter. Stick to them this week.
2. You're not alone—every woman in that room is fighting the same battle.
3. If you want support going deeper, I offer 1:1 coaching—reply to book a free discovery call.

Remember: You cannot rescue others from a place of empty. Fill your tank first.

With love,

Chelsea Flynn